

Title: Free and Easy Fine Motor Skill Builders for Kindy Kids

As a parent and educator, I often get asked how to support fine motor development at home. This blog was inspired by a friend who recently reached out about her son — and it's a question I hear often.

At Mumma Chelles, I'm passionate about helping families, educators, and carers nurture children's growth with simple, meaningful strategies — including the everyday magic of fine motor play.

Fine motor skills are the small muscle movements in our hands and fingers — the kind we use to hold a pencil, zip up a jacket, or button a shirt. For kindy kids aged 3-5, these skills are a big part of becoming more independent and school-ready.

The kindy year is a special time full of growth, discovery, and preparation for the exciting school years ahead. It's a year where children build not just academic readiness, but a whole toolkit of essential life skills — including **fine motor strength, emotional development, confidence, and connection.**

The best part? You don't need fancy tools or expensive toys to support these milestones. Just a few simple, everyday items and playful moments together can make a lasting difference.

Here are some of my favourite **free (or very low-cost) activities** that support fine motor development — and create beautiful opportunities for bonding and emotional growth too.



Cutting and Snipping

- Give your child scrap paper, magazines, or junk mail to practice cutting with child-safe scissors.
- Draw wavy, zigzag, or straight lines on paper and encourage them to follow along with scissors. *(These activities support scissor control, visual tracking, and coordination — essential for early writing skills.)*



Pincer Grip and Hand Strength

- Let them clip pegs onto cardboard, boxes, or hang up socks on a line.
- Use tweezers or fingers to pick up and sort pom-poms, beads, or buttons.
- Offer sticker peeling activities (great for fine control and patience!).
- Try threading dry pasta or large beads onto string or shoelaces. *(Great for developing grip strength, dexterity, and control needed for holding pencils and using tools.)*



Pre-Writing and Drawing

- Draw on the footpath or chalkboard with thick chalk.
- Print your child's name or simple shapes and have them trace over them.
- Let them colour inside shapes or draw freely.
- Fill a tray with salt or flour and let them write letters or shapes with their finger or a small brush. *(These activities support hand-eye coordination, control, and early literacy awareness.)*



Construction Play

- Make your own playdough and encourage rolling, pinching, and shaping. (Need a simple recipe? Click here for my go-to homemade playdough recipe)
- Build with blocks, Lego, or Duplo to strengthen small hand muscles.
- Tear scrap paper and glue it into creative collages. *(Encourages problem-solving, hand strength, and creative thinking.)*

Self-Help Skills

- Practice buttoning, zipping, and lacing on their own clothes or dress-up dolls.
- Help in the kitchen by stirring, pouring, or peeling boiled eggs.
- Let them wash toys or pegs using a sponge to wring and scrub. *(Builds independence and confidence while strengthening fine motor coordination.)*

Games and Play

- Sing songs with hand movements like “Heads, Shoulders, Knees and Toes” or “If You’re Happy and You Know It” from the Mumma Chelles Playlist.
- Play simple board games or puzzles that involve turning small pieces.
- Let them draw with fingers in shaving cream or paint spread on a table or tray. *(These fun moments also support rhythm, turn-taking, listening, and emotional regulation.)*

All of these activities help build coordination, grip strength, and independence — skills your child will use every single day in their life — whether at home, in the classroom, or out in the world. But they also support **emotional regulation, rhythm and routine, and social connection** — especially when paired with songs and playful interaction. That’s why I created the **Spotify playlist: “Sing, Move, Grow”**, full of my favourite action songs that support not just motor skills, but **language, listening, turn-taking, and emotional expression** too. 🎵 [Listen to the Playlist: “Sing, Move, Grow”](#)

To make things even easier, you can also grab your **free printable Fine Motor Activity Checklist** — perfect for the fridge, homeschool space, classroom wall, or sharing with families: 👉 [Download the Fine Motor Checklist here](#)

Looking for more school readiness tips, free resources, or simple learning ideas? Come connect with me on Facebook or Instagram — I’d love to hear what’s working for you and your little learners! And while you're there, feel free to browse the lovely things we do sell in the Mumma Chelles store too (because sometimes even the best homemade playdough needs a buddy).

Every snip, stir, and squish your child does is helping them grow — not just in skills, but in confidence. With just a few everyday materials and moments of connection, you’re giving them the best kind of kindy year: one filled with joy, learning, and love.